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UAE health care licensing gets major overhaul

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Faculty members at the UAE's medical colleges and universities will now be able to practise at health care facilities, while nursing and allied health graduates will no longer have to wait six months before entering the workforce, thanks to amendments made to the health care licensing system announced yesterday.

The Ministry of Health and Prevention (MoHAP), in coordination with the ministries of Higher Education and Human Resources, said faculty members, including physicians and other health professionals, will be permitted to work within health care facilities alongside their academic roles. Teaching hours will count toward Continuing Professional Development requirements, in line with approved medical education policies.

No more waiting

The waiver of the six-month experience rule applies to registered nurses, assistant nurses, medical laboratory technicians and technologists, respiratory care technicians and health care assistants. Importantly, this covers graduates from both within the UAE and abroad.

The move comes as part of efforts to improve the efficiency of the licensing system and better align it with labour market needs.

SEE ALSO P2

TRUMP SAYS IRAN SOUGHT TRUCE; TEHRAN SAYS 'FALSE AND BASELESS'

US president ties truce to Hormuz reopening as Iran stands firm

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said yesterday that Iran is seeking a ceasefire, but Tehran swiftly rejected the assertion as "false and baseless," highlighting sharply conflicting claims as the war intensifies.

Speaking ahead of an address to the American people, Trump said Iran's leadership wanted a ceasefire, linking any pause in fighting to the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump also referred to "Iran's new regime president" in his remarks — despite no change in Iran's presidency — adding to confusion over his claim.

He said any ceasefire would only be considered once the Strait of Hormuz is "open, free and clear," tying diplomacy directly to the reopening of the critical oil route.

'Back to the Stone Ages'

"Until then, we are blasting Iran into oblivion... back to the Stone Ages," he wrote on Truth Social.

Iran dismissed the claim. Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei said the remarks were "false and baseless," while the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps said the strait remains firmly under its control and will not be opened under pressure.

Foreign Minister Abbas



■ Rescue workers battle flames engulfing vehicles at the site of an Israeli airstrike in Beirut, Lebanon, yesterday. Lebanon said over 1,300 people have died due to the Israel-Hezbollah war.

Araghchi signalled continued resistance, saying: "We do not set any deadline for defending ourselves."

The US is reinforcing its presence, with the aircraft carrier USS George H.W. Bush and accompanying destroyers heading to the region. Thousands of troops from the 82nd Airborne Division are also deploying.

The conflict's spillover is intensifying across the Gulf.

In the UAE, a Bangladeshi national was killed in Fujairah after drone debris fell on a farm, as air defences engaged 5 ballistic missiles and 35 drones originating from Iran.

Qatar said a tanker linked to its state energy company was struck by a missile in its territorial waters, while Kuwait reported a drone attack on fuel facilities that triggered a large fire.

Despite tensions, limited shipping continues. Pakistani-flagged vessels have transited Hormuz, with more expected after Islamabad said Tehran had allowed additional ships through in a "constructive gesture."

The Strait of Hormuz remains a critical artery for global oil flows, heightening urgency for de-escalation.

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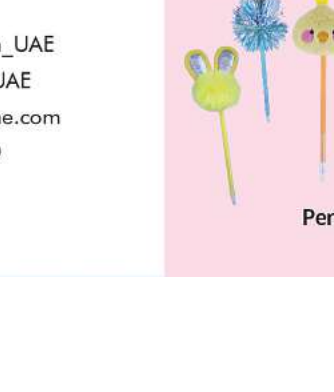
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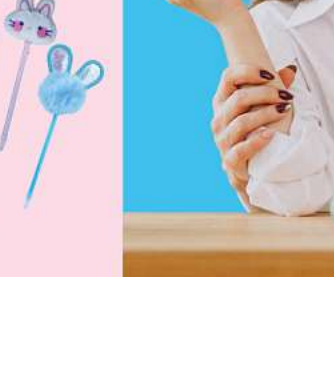
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